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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Wednesday, April 12, 2023

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[00:27:28] good morning and welcome to the april meeting of the college partnership laboratory school standing committee i'm going to have the clerk call the role in advance of this meeting i have approved the remote participation of mr rotherham and mr hanson mr chapman please call the role yes chairperson miss joan wadiska present vice chair dr pam moran mr john bailey present mr andy Rotherham. Here. Mr. Bill Hansen. Here. Thank you. Please stand and join me in a moment of silence

[00:28:06] that will be followed by the Pledge of Allegiance. The Pledge of Allegiance. The flag of the United States of America, to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible,

[00:28:39] liberty, justice. Thank you. At this time, I'd seek a motion from the committee to approve the agenda as presented. Is there a motion? So moved. Is there a second? Second. All those in favor of approving the agenda as presented, please signify by saying aye. Aye. Aye. Any opposed? All right.

[00:29:07] Motion carries. We can proceed with our agenda as presented. We'll now take up the approval of the minutes. The staff transmitted the draft of the March minutes to you in advance of this meeting on April 6th. Are there any corrections to the minutes as distributed? Hearing none and there's no further corrections. The minutes stand approved as, stand approved as distributed. We'll now proceed with public comments. The standing committee accepts public comment on all matters

[00:29:43] related to college partnership laboratory schools in Virginia. Public comment is an important consideration and valued input to the standing committee. Public comments on agenda items will be accepted as the item is called. Public comments on non-agenda items will be accepted upon the conclusion of the business portion of this meeting. Should there be multiple members of the public seeking to comment on a specific agenda item or non-agenda item, commenters will be recognized in the order in which they were requested to provide feedback to the VDOE website. For the benefit of the committee and for the public record, we ask that commenters please state their name and the

[00:30:21] organization at the beginning of their remarks. Commenters will be limited to three minutes as the standard procedure for the State Board of Ed. Given the time and cost to travel to Richmond, and again for the public benefit and the benefit of the public record, the Standing Committee welcomes and encourages the public to submit written comments to the committee. As a reminder, written comments may be submitted on the web form that is available on the Standing Committee's page on the vdoe website all comments received through the web form will be provided to the standing committee in advance of its next scheduled meeting and we want to thank again the public for their

[00:31:00] input and their feedback your input is welcomed and greatly appreciated mr chapman at this time i don't believe we have any public commenters but i do want to just check with you that's correct okay thank you now we'll proceed with the action items and discussion items for consideration today. The first is item A, final review of the final and second review and final approval of the College Lab Partnership Committee application process. And I believe this item is going to be presented by Mr. Chapman. Mr. Chapman, please take it away. Yes, thank you, Chair Wodiska,

[00:31:35] Vice Chair, Dr. Moran, members of the committee. What we have here on final review, this item remains unchanged since the committee saw this item back in the March meeting. This is a large scale overview of exactly what the department and the committee members have worked together to establish as a process for how a lab school application will move from the moment it is received from the department all the way through to when it is moved before the Board of Education and the Board of Education makes a decision on that application. You can see this is a very

[00:32:10] detailed you know presentation we try to include as many of the steps from from receipt through an internal review process that will happen with vdoe i will go ahead and call attention to the fact that on the agenda on item d you have a couple of items that that really expand upon this particular aspect of what's what we what we think should happen at the department level as it engages its own subject matter experts to review a college partnership lab school application um and so so at least uh later in the agenda you will see a significant expansion of the second tier of what

[00:32:48] we think will happen and what we what we're presenting to you for approval of what will happen within the vdoe once we receive that application and how we move by about coaching an applicant um and and really refining an application before it gets to you all for consideration and of course once the the application gets into the lab school standing committee once your review and work begins this process lays out what will happen at first review that an applicant will join us here uh you know either virtually or in person in order to present the application along with staff how we will have material for you to help with the review of the

[00:33:27] application from the virginia department of education subject matter experts and then what What happens with public comment after you all are satisfied with an application and that it is in a

condition and presentable and all your questions have been addressed, how that will be posted for public comment on the VDE website, utilizing some of our new Microsoft forms and such to get you detailed comment the way you would like it.

[00:33:52] I will come back to you on a second review in order for you to consider, you know, with the public comment and be able to ask final questions to an applicant before then finalizing A REPORT AND MOVING THAT ON TO THE VIRGINIA DEPART -- OR TO THE BOARD -- THE FULL BOARD OF EDUCATION FOR CONSIDERATION OF THE APPLICATION FOR APPROVAL THERE.

[00:34:10] MR. CHAPMAN, THANK YOU. AT THIS TIME, I WOULD OPEN IT UP FOR A DISCUSSION OR COMMENTS FROM LAB COMMITTEE MEMBERS. I'LL START WITH THE INDIVIDUALS PRESENT IN THE ROOM AND THEN WE'LL GO TO MR. ROTHRHAM OR MR. HANSOM. ANY COMMENTS?

[00:34:27] that my one question is from start to finish do you have a sense of time frames because we've got a couple places where we've gated times in there 10 days for public comment 90 days to get the contract but once an application comes in is there a sense of whether we should or should not be at least putting some reasonable gate on how long it would take for say staff to

[00:35:04] do the review yeah and to have that added into this yes dr. man that's an excellent question thank you I think the the best answer we can give at the moment is that really depends upon the nature of the application as you'll remember from the presentation that dr. Albin gave at the last standing committee meeting there's such a wide variety of proposals currently on the table, ranging with everything from early childhood education, straight up through, you know, involvement in very specific and detailed industries. And so, you know, a lot of that answer is going to depend on the nature of the partnership that's with local school divisions, the strength

[00:35:41] of the partnership with local industry partners, and certainly the general complexity of what the proposal entails. At some points, having a freestanding structure will be looked at very differently and require a very different level of review than, you know, something that's really embedded in a more strategic partnership with local school divisions. And so we don't have a good sense. Of course, I think also internally, once the department receives an application, the expectation is going to be that we are in communication with that applicant as soon as possible, both letting them know that the application has been received to starting our

[00:36:19] own internal subject matter review. But the length of time in that stage and the extent of the coaching that's involved in getting a proposal that's ready to be viewed by the standing committee is really where we have to defer that to the process and making sure that the proposal is ready rather than just trying to stick to a more rigid time frame. Just one other question too. It looks like the, first of all, I appreciate this is so clearly laid out, and I think that's a huge

[00:36:56] benefit for not just us, but for the applicants, too. But the one, about three quarters of the way through the page where B2E receives the application, and then if it's incomplete, it goes back to the applicant, is that feedback loop just to make sure everything's complete, or can they materially change the material that's actually in the responses. Can you just elaborate a little bit more on that, Luke? Yeah, I think at any point, the applicant is able to materially change the application based on what they plan to present. Now, what we end up doing with that

[00:37:32] may be something a little bit different depending on where it is in the stage. Certainly, the point at which everything becomes much more concrete is we think once an application gets posted for public comment, you know, at that point, we've really given the public, this is the application, this is the proposal that's on the table. And certainly once it goes before the Board of Education and gets approved at that point, like the proposal is really set in stone.

[00:37:53] But I think with the process and, you know, thank you to Chair Wodiska for her, you know, substantial input on this point. When it's in that BDOE process, then really we consider that like the revision to get to you all to the standing committee. And how long that takes the nature of the revisions really depends on on the type of proposal again that's that's on the table um but we we do think that that is the port the part where what we are looking to do internally and this will become more clear with the um the attachments in item d as they're considered and what that videoe internal subject matter review um you know experts uh will look

[00:38:29] like um i think what we envision is that's the opportunity to make sure that as many of the questions that we can answer ahead of time and make sure that this is not a compliance check in the strict sense of like, you are wrong, you are right. What it is, is a compliance check to make sure that there's enough information in the application that you all can discern that this is a lab school that is going to comport not only with Virginia law, it's not going to comply with Virginia law. It looks like it gives you everything you need to see that in the application process.

[00:39:01] So we, as the internal review within BDOE, that I think is the goal constantly, is to make sure that the application has as much information present so that the standing committee can determine that this is ready to move forward. Sure.

[00:39:18] Mr. Hanson or Mr. Rotherham, do either of you have remarks you'd like to make on this particular item? I'm sorry that I can't see a, the screen doesn't prompt me to see if you have an item that you'd like to raise for like a raised hand. So I'll continually ask that as we go through today's agenda, just to ensure that you can fully participate in the meeting. Thank you. Appreciate that. No, not on this item. This is good work. I think this is a really good tool to vote for applicants and for the public. Thank you. Before I ask for a motion on this item, I do want to

[00:39:58] entertain just a couple remarks myself. First is I really want to thank staff. This was a very difficult task and required not only some really thoughtful work on how to create a process that supports innovation, that really partners with applicants to support them, but that how would you show that in a document that's on one page that supports role clarity? And that was really important when we were talking with staff, it was very important that it is clear who is responsible

[00:40:35] for which part of this process and how can we collaborate and coordinate together. And this document not only delineates the roles and responsibilities at each part of the journey of an applicant, an application review, but it also for the applicants will provide a predictable path.

[00:40:58] And for the public, it too creates a predictable path for when and where and how they will be able to participate in the process. One other thought that I want to share with this item is that there are kind of three, or excuse me, four recommendations that will be coming out of this approval today that will be recommendations to the state board on behalf of the lab committee.

[00:41:25] And our intention with this process document is really to create, I think as Dr. Moran has referred to it, as an ecosystem to support innovation, that we are learning as we go, and we're applying that learning, and we're sharing that learning broadly across the Commonwealth for the benefit of all.

[00:41:45] And to that end, we know that this is not the first time that Virginia has entertained lab schools. It is not the first time that Virginia has considered innovation, such as governor's schools, and that all of these provide us with a history, a learning, a data, a knowledge base that can help improve this work.

[00:42:09] And so when we get further on into today's agenda, we'll talk a little bit about how to start putting some of those building blocks in place to build this ecosystem. But the first leg of this process was to lay out the process for everyone to transparently see.

[00:42:27] But the four recommendations that will be made by the Lab Committee to the State Board through this document will be the following. Number one, we are suggesting the creation of a professional learning community for the planning grant winners so that they can support one another, compare notes with one another, that they feel support as they are uniquely trying to do something in Virginia.

[00:42:54] The second is that we are supporting, and this is really important, and you heard this in Mr. Chapman's remarks, we are encouraging the support of intensive technical assistance and coaching. Often, when we're working with state agencies, unfortunately, sometimes an applicant can feel as if it's a binary decision.

[00:43:18] It's either a yes, you can approve, or it's a no, you're done. And in this situation, in this process, because we know that we are working with applicants in the higher education institutions that may not be as familiar with the requirements to operate a K-12 school in Virginia, the obligation and the responsibility is to support that applicant, to ensure that they have the necessary information and that they understand the requirements before them so that they can do that job successfully.

[00:43:49] And so this process is envisioning more intensive TA may be needed, and as we'll hear later again in today's agenda, for the two applicants we currently have moving through the process, we're learning they do need more support, and we want that support to be available to them.

[00:44:13] The third recommendation that is going to be made to the State Board of Education is the creation of a professional learning community for the lab schools. So if and when lab schools are approved through this process, the creation of a professional learning community for those institutions to work together to share information will be essential.

[00:44:41] lastly, the process before that we're considering, given the diligence of the lab committee, given the diligence that we'll be going through with the public process, the approval process does envision the opportunity that the state board may, given this diligence, may approve a lab school as second reading, having utilized the committee process here. So we know that we'll be doing a diligent process. We know this process will take time. Should the state board want to be

[00:45:19] able to approve a lab school following the recommendation of the lab committee, that they would have the opportunity to do so. It doesn't mean they have to do so. They obviously bear that decision, that final decision is always theirs, but should they want to expedite that process, they would have the opportunity to do so. And that is a reflection of the utilization of a committee process to help with

workload for the State Board. So those are kind of the four points that I wanted to make sure were illuminated. Okay, that hasn't been said. Is there a motion to approve this item?

[00:45:55] I'd like to make a motion to approve the College Partnership Laboratory Committee application process as it has been presented is there a second second all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye aye motion carries thank you all right we'll now proceed thank you mr chapman and thank you miss velasquez all right now we'll move to item b which is an update on the lab school applications dr album i believe this item is for you yes ma'am thank you

[00:46:33] so um thank you sorry okay i was informed that this microphone works a little better so i'm up here so just a little bit of an update with regards to where we stand with our current lab school applications um having been a high school mathematics teacher i realized that not everyone always understood everything that i said when i said it which was especially hard when you have an accent so i tended to do well when i taught using a lot of analogy and my son is a champion

[00:47:09] gifted runner he's probably one of the top distance runners in the country and if we were to run a 5k race he would probably get there in 15 minutes and i'd be happy to get there in 50 minutes if you take a look at the lab school process and where we are we may have some applicants that are going to come ready and fast and be able to sail through so to answer some of the questions just the nature of of the applications themselves will determine the length of time before an applicant goes from submitting an application to being presented to you.

[00:47:44] The second piece of that is this is a process that was started well over 10 years ago. And the guide poster we have for lab schools is in the Code of Virginia. It's chapter 19.1 of the Code of Virginia. And in there, that is what the finish line looks like. So back to my analogy, if we are in the starting point, we know what the finishing point looks like. The finishing point is what chapter 19.1 of the code of virginia lays out for us the challenge that we have is that we don't know the course and we don't know which route to take we don't know what is what the guidelines are

[00:48:21] what the guideposts are the code is very explicit and clear but understanding exactly how to get from here to there is what we need to work with our institutes of higher education applicants to be able to get there so a lot of what we're speaking about today is presenting documents presenting information to be able to put out to lab school applicants, whether they come in as a planning grant applicant or even as a full lab school applicant to say, here is the roadmap, here's the starting line, here's what the finish line looks like, and here's the route that you

[00:48:55] need to take. As you are aware, we are building this and putting it out as publicly as is possible. Now, I absolutely applaud the two applicants who have submitted applications to us because they are at the start line the code is the finish line and they are trying to get there the problem is the roadmaps weren't provided to them when they first submitted these applications that's what we're doing today that's what this committee is building and approving so if you take a look at the document that you just looked at in item a there is a process that we need to go to in order to support a lab school applicant to have an application that is

[00:49:34] ready to present to this standing committee. And a big piece of that is that the application be complete and it be compliant. Compliancy is written out in part three of chapter 19.1, where it speaks about how the lab school needs to comply with the code of Virginia, needs to comply with the standards of quality, needs to comply with the standards of accreditation, needs to comply with the standards of

learning. The applicants who have put out some really good and interesting ideas, we have been working back and forth with them, providing technical assistance

[00:50:14] to get a feedback loop to understand exactly how they are going to be able to comply with those things. We've had no doubt in the quality or the idea of what they want to do. We are just in different phases in working with them in ensuring that when we are able to to support them bringing an application to this board that they have been able to show a complete application that communicates how they will comply with all of those things so our two applicants that we have been working with have received technical assistance from the department of education

[00:50:50] the things that we've primarily been looking at is policy are they compliant are they going to be able to be fiscally sustainable we've been speaking with them about funding how is that going to work and then are they going to be ready to put all of this together in a school in an environment that does comply with the definition of a lab school many great ideas don't necessarily fit with the definition of a lab school in 0.1 of the code. So what we've been working with, we've, with one

[00:51:24] applicant, we, they submitted an application. We took an internal review of their application. We had a meeting, a technical assistance meeting with them, gave them time to go back and to resubmit their application to us. And actually we received that just yesterday. So we are in the very beginning stages of internal Department of Education staff looking at the application, providing feedback, going through it so that some of the documents that you will see later on today in item D will be able to help us to present to you how they have complied with everything that

[00:52:02] fits into lab schools. With the other applicant, they did submit an application and we are still in the phases of meeting with them to try to better understand what their application is trying to convey to us does it comply it may it may require a resubmission from them so that they can communicate better what it is that they are attempting to do or even give them the opportunity to make some changes so that they can comply with that so we are working through if you look at item a we're working through that second row we are providing technical assistance so that when they

[00:52:41] get to you, you should have less concern about being able to review the application. Our entire goal is to bring to you applications that will be successful. We don't want them to stand before you or the board and to have a hard no. We want to be able to make sure that as applications are presented to you, they will be able to show we know that this is a concern. Here is how we've prepared for it. We know this is a compliance. Here is how we are ready for that and how we will have processes.

[00:53:14] So we're in the phase of coaching them so that when they get to you, we will be able to have lab schools up and running here in Virginia. Thank you. Questions or comments from members of the lab committee?

[00:53:31] I'm really interested in that as you are looking at points, and there are a lot in the pipeline, either at the planning phase and a few actually starting to move towards the real deal or we really want to get open with our lab school. is it possible that you might capture when people are making decisions about what they want to include in their grant that may not be in compliance that if you could capture those so that

[00:54:05] we could almost create a concept map of this is these are things that that if you go down this pathway this could put you out of compliance yes so that it gives people a little sense of what where some

of those pitfalls are absolutely so the two things that we're doing is our largest hurdles that we are coming up with with the applicants we try to put that up front in the faqs on the website as well as provide the communication within the documents so that it's instead of one of the challenges that we are going to have with lab schools is we want people to be creative

[00:54:40] we want people to color outside of the lines however we still want them to be headed north and with that there will be curving there will be movement the other piece that we are doing is we are actually working to modify the application itself so it's a lot clearer for the applicants as they are completing the application oh this is important so as they're putting it in they are communicating how they're going to address something that might be a concern or it may even give them pause to say we can't do that that way so we're trying to be a lot more clearer and explicit with the application form and then the guidelines as well just to put out here are the

[00:55:20] big hurdles here are the things that are deal breakers for our two virtual participants any comments on this agenda item none from me bill all right all right thank you that's an excellent update thank you very much i really appreciate that i appreciate all your leadership on this work thank you very much all right with that we're going to move to item c which is preview of

[00:55:55] revisions of the lab school application. Mrs. Velasquez will present this item to the standing committee. Vinesky, excuse me, wrong staff member, my apology. So as Dr. Albin had explained a little bit, one of our goals is to update the tools that the applicants have to flow through this process.

[00:56:23] The original lab school application was designed in 2012, and now as we're receiving applications, we're we're we're looking at the application and going back and saying, here's our lessons learned.

[00:56:38] And how can we improve on this application overall? How can we improve on the questions that we're asking and probing responses that include the completeness and the compliance requirements that we're looking for? so um this draft revision is expands on the 31 items the 31 elements that are in the virginia statute 19.1 the code by including detailed requests for information on public school operational data so it would so their the applicant's response would clearly indicate

[00:57:18] completeness and compliance so the overall goal of the draft lab school application revision is to improve the overall application experience for the institutes of higher learning and minimize the need to go back and request clarifying information and thereby shortening the time frame for approval and ultimate implementation of a lab school some of the items that we're that are shown in the revision are for example more information on building specs if it's a

[00:57:57] standalone operation and not closely tied to a public school or a divisional school requests for operational policies on safety health curriculum design and then also more complete information on the financial planning the revenue and expenses and that's some of the highlights but there's been an overall look back based on our lessons learned in the initial review of the

[00:58:29] applications. Thank you, Mrs. Vinesky. I really want to give you just tremendous gratitude and appreciation for the work that you have done to help apply what we're learning as we're going and refine and make refined recommendations to the application process so that it'll further educate and prompt applicants to be successful through this process. And again, for the work that you've done on the prior

process document, we wouldn't be at this stage in the process if it wasn't for your your technical assistance and your your counsel so let's see if we have any

[00:59:08] questions or comments all right this thank you very much i believe in the next step in the process having provided uh us with a preview of these revisions it's my understanding that the next step in the process is that the application will be shared internally at vdoe across the subject matter experts. They will look at those, the revised application, and as just as Dr. Moran has suggested, as we're seeing questions that are prompting a learning moment, that the application

[00:59:47] will be further refined to prompt that type of input or response so that an applicant could be successful. So I would fully anticipate lab committee members that we may see a future iteration of the application and as we continue on this process say six eight nine months from now a year from now we could see another version of the application and that is really trying to embody this mindset of we're learning we're applying that learning just as we're encouraging our applicants to do we too as a standing committee will be doing that in our own processes correct refining the

[01:00:23] process as we move through thank you very much all right now we're going to move to parking lot d And it's a multi-floor, multi-level parking garage. We've been talking about putting together the building blocks to create this ecosystem to support innovation, to build out a transparent process that is supportive of applicants.

[01:00:49] To create that transparent process requires us to have a number of documents. And all of these items are previewed for you here in item D. These documents are currently pending an update and revisions by the Virginia Department of Education. Mr. Chapman, did you want to walk through these items broadly and provide the lab committee and the public with an update on the various pieces of the ecosystem?

[01:01:19] Yes, absolutely. Thank you, Chair Wadiska, Vice President, Vice Chair Dr. Moran, members of the committee. Yeah, as Chair Wadiska mentioned, what we have here is really the skeletal structure that's starting to emerge of what all of this process looks like on the ground.

[01:01:35] So, you know, we've got the broad picture that's been painted in the document that you approved in item A. And now these are the sort of nitty gritty documents that are going to get us through each step of that process. So for you on final review, Attachment A and Attachment B, these are really the processes working from the sort of at the end of the standing committee's work, moving, you know, backward.

[01:02:00] What we have here is, in Attachment A, is the evaluation rubric that we're going to be asking, you know, asking for you all to use in order to evaluate a lab school application once you receive it, once it's been through the VDU internal review.

[01:02:18] This is the rubric based on state law, on what's in the statutes in Chapter 19.1 of Title 22.1 of the Code of Virginia, as well as the information that the VDOE subject matter experts in the internal review will be providing to kind of help you all analyze the application.

[01:02:36] And this will be what we're asking for you to fill out to bring to the committee meeting so that when you discuss it, we have these items that we can start to compile and use to generate attachment B. Attachment B is ultimately the real work product that comes out of the standing committee, which is a recommendation to the state board. So that once the application moves to the state board, this is the

template in attachment B of what we think that your report should look like. Here is the information that you've compiled, everything that has come through the VDOE process that has then bubbled up into the

[01:03:12] standing committee, all of the information that the standing committee has gathered from talking with the applicant at first review and at second review, the public comment that the standing committee has received on the application and the time between those two reviews, all of that then funnels and gets, you know, merged into this report that ends up going to the state board.

[01:03:33] So these are really the two tools, you know, that the standing committee is going to be using to accomplish its work. What we have then, you know, continuing to sort of work backward in the process and attachments C, D, and E are different aspects of what we think the VDOE needs to be doing in order to prepare the standing committee to fill out its rubric in attachment A, and then to ultimately generate the report in attachment B. And so in attachment C, we have a much more expanded version of this internal process with VDUE that includes information

[01:04:11] about how the subject matter experts are gathered together. You know, again, incredible thanks to Ms. Vinesky for her work on this document, as well as the other documents in this process Attachment D is going to be exactly what the work product that we provide to you, what the department provides to the standing committee, the sort of compilation of wisdom that we have internally and what the review of the application is, how we weigh in on various aspects of the application.

[01:04:46] We will provide that to you in attachment D so that you can then fill out your own rubrics that ultimately gets into the standing committee report in attachment B. And then attachment E is really what the protocol is internally that we think BDU should follow in order to get its internal experts together to convene them who ends up being the lead.

[01:05:12] you know, Chair Wadiska is really a big believer in role clarity. And I think you see the influence of that in this document of making sure we have a good process. That way, the process is durable. As the VDOE, you know, personnel move in and out, of course, you know, we hope that we keep all of our great employees for long periods of time, but we know that also we do have movement internally.

[01:05:34] So we are clear on whose responsibility the role is assigned to and how that role contributes to the larger process and the work that you all are doing so you know in in the bulk again you know we have two documents on final review that i think we are hoping to get approved and then other documents that are starting to flesh out how this process gets to you all and again how this moves from an application ultimately bubbling up through the standing committee and and moving to the state board with a clean work product thank you mr chapman that was excellent uh questions or comments

[01:06:06] from members of the committee at this time we could entertain the approval of attachment a i'm sorry chair i think i might have heard a murmur on the mr rotherham or mr hanson no all i did this is this is good work and i think this level of granularity is really important and a lot went into this and so uh i want to commend both the chair for her uh diligence and time on this and also staff for just really great work thank you thank you it's a good team all right we can

[01:06:45] so a quick discussion item for the lab committee members we could approve item a and b these items were presented at the last committee meeting we could also wait and give a further opportunity for bdoe to review those items as we'll be having a transition this month and you know i'm i'm

of mind we could do either i just want to check in with you i mean we could approve them i i feel comfortable approving them because again if we're really embodying a model of innovation here we we know there's going to be changes to these documents we know we're going to have improvements we know

[01:07:25] we're going to have refinements i do see a value in approving those two items today should we need them we have them now um and and maybe we will need them in the coming month or two um but i do want to just stay open the door on our entire work we really do need to refine this process both for our work as well as will for for the applicant so if there isn't objection i would

[01:07:56] suggest that we i would entertain a motion to approve uh attachment a and b as presented there we go uh yes i support the motion i'll i'll submit the motion in a minute just i i the reason i think this is important is what staff have done in an amazing way is just helped clarify this and give a lot of clarity and remove a lot of uncertainty for applicants and for ourselves so i think approving these two items realizing we might come back to it later also is in that spirit

[01:08:36] of removing some uncertainty and giving us a little bit of more direction but also giving applicants as well so um so i submit uh the motion for approving items a and b uh as as submitted excellent is there a second second all those in favor of approving attachment a and attachment b as presented please signify by saying aye aye any opposed this any opposed an a that's that's unanimous item attachment a and attachment b are approved as presented thank you committee members and thank you very much to the staff and team for working through this process with us all right now

[01:09:15] we will proceed with item e which is very exciting which is a presentation from dr album to give us an update on what's going on with the college partnership laboratory school planning grants excellent thank you very much so i will start off by mentioning that i'm going to share with you some new answers that are built on that which i shared with you last month and also the presentation that i made to the board of education last month as well since our last meeting we've

[01:09:51] not had any new applications but there is some interesting work that is going on out in the planning grant application world so i'd like to share that with you as well as create a larger framework of where we stand so to go back to the lab schools interactive map this is our current map that is found on our website with this we have been able to communicate as a professional learning environment more than just a community to all current and future applicants about where the applications are happening and how they are moving forward you will if you go there you will

[01:10:29] be able to click on an application and there is a plethora of information about that applicant itself. You will be able to see who the Institute of Higher Education is. You'll be able to see what kind of program they are looking to put in place. You'll also be able to see a short summary about the application itself, what the nature of their proposed program is. But also what is really beneficial is there are contact details there for the applicants themselves. I may very well be thinking if I'm an institute of higher ed wanting to put forward a plan and grant application

[01:11:06] I may be quite interested in taking a look to see what's in the water and to be able to see oh there's something that's happening in a different part of the state that's similar to what I'm thinking about let me reach out to that university or that community college or that institution to be able to bounce some ideas off of all of the applicants that you have already seen are farther down the road than any new applicant coming in so it would behoove them to be able to do that at the same time what it also does is it does communicate to the greater community the parents

[01:11:42] the families the industries around virginia about what is happening in their neighborhood we have several applications that are pinpointing different parts of industry and are and are looking to support lab schools in being able to provide a space whereby students are going to be exposed to learning opportunities that they may not have anywhere else. So that may be an incentive for a business to come in alongside and to support them. Added to which it might encourage some parents to say, I really like what's happening in that part of Virginia. Why is it not happening

[01:12:19] over here? And they might prompt some further applications down the road. I will share with that we did when you go to the lab schools webpage and you do see this map on the webpage you will also notice that as of yesterday every single planning grant applicant and every single lab school applicant their actual applications are now available online the full application document is available to anyone to be able to pull down and to see what is written it's very very very important that the greater community understand particularly with regards to the planning grant

[01:12:58] applications that is not the final product and that may not be what the actual lab school will look like when the time comes the lab school applications would and should be a little bit closer but even that is not what may not be exactly what the lab school will look like it is just where they currently stand in submission of their plans going forward so that provides a a little bit of information. There is absolutely nothing edited. There is absolutely nothing that is held back, but it provides information to the full public for them to be able to see

[01:13:33] the actual nature of every single one of those applications that is on that map. Now, as shared previously, we are working to get a prettier map, which is only going to show West Virginia. We do love traveling to the other states, but we like focusing only on Virginia, as well as being able to communicate something that is a little bit more like this so that it does identify the superintendent's regions.

[01:14:00] I'm partial to region five, so I might focus on the yellow block, who's going to be in my region, what colleges are there, et cetera. That is what the future map will look like. So just some information about the applicants and the applications themselves.

[01:14:17] I'm going to jump out of order just a little bit for you. We have many applications that are in the water, and these are a little bit of the planning grants. They are planning grant applications that focus on career and technical education preparation, being able to take a student to walk out of high school and walk directly into a career.

[01:14:38] That is built very similarly on some of our Governor's School STEM labs, some of our CTE partners, but it might take it a lot deeper, as we've seen in some applications. We've got an application out with Wallops Island to be able to work with getting students to be ready to work in the space industry.

[01:14:57] We've got some healthcare industry applications out there where students at the high school are going to be able to reach even higher levels of credentialing before they graduate high school. We also have teacher preparation lab schools where we will have students be able to walk down the pathway of becoming a teacher such that after high school, within two years, they will be a fully licensed teacher at the age of 20.

[01:15:25] We've got some lab schools that are going in and supporting school divisions that are going to help to use some university research and expertise to support early literacy. We also have some lab schools that are wanting to start up in the STEM space.

[01:15:42] Now, I sort of have to slow down because this is a bias of mine. I love the idea of having some of our universities who the coursework that happens at the university often requires students to have one foot in science, maybe one foot in math. And they've been living in the land of how do we blend calculus and physics and how do we do that at the university level?

[01:16:04] but they're working with students who've never had to experience that cross-silo work. So they're wanting to create lab schools that are going to give kids those opportunities. That is something I highly desire because it is something I would love to see in more schools across the Commonwealth.

[01:16:20] We do have some lab schools that we do have a lab school application that is going to help students to be prepared to work in the shipbuilding industry. As you know, Virginia has a very large shipbuilding industry, and we have an application out in the Norfolk area that is going to be able to support that.

[01:16:40] We do essentially have two models of lab school applications that are happening. The one is an on-IHE campus school, and that is where the school itself is going to exist on the campus of the applicant. So that might be at the community college or at the university.

[01:16:57] students will no longer go to their K-12 school that they've gone to, they will actually attend school on the university campus. That is actually closer to the true definition of a lab school, and it would, it certainly does help with a lot of other complications and applications if applicants were leaning more towards having their lab schools based on the campus of the university itself. The code requires that lab schools be operated and run by the university.

[01:17:29] So when it is situated on the campus itself, it's a lot easier to be under the authority of the university. We do have some other models that are coming that are providing for a school within a school, and that may very well be where students will still go to their traditional school. They may still ride the bus. They may still participate in athletics at their base school close to where they live. However, from, let's say, 8 a.m. to 3.30 p.m., they are living in a school within a school, in a place, in a space that is operated and run by the university, where the university

[01:18:06] might be working in partnership or more directly with the students in that school to give them these lab school opportunities. And as shared previously, some of the foci that we are seeing amongst the multitude of applicants are career preparation, teacher preparation, early literacy support, innovative instruction models. We have some applicants who are having students that will still graduate high school at the end. However, they're wanting to say perhaps there's a difference or there's a better way of instructing students. Then also providing

[01:18:39] some lab schools that are going to get students more toward early college. In the slides that do go into this. You'll be able to see the applicants who have come in. They've come from every single region in the state. You'll be able to work out who is specifically in there. I'm not going to go through all of those today for you, but those are all there and they are public and they are able for anyone to be able to get a summary document of all of the planning grant applicants that have come in thus far. You will see some interesting ones like on this slide.

[01:19:18] We've got a pre-K application, and that is where a lab school is hoping to do some work before students even come to school. We've got some elementary school, some middle school, some high school

applications that are coming in. So I'd like to jump back just a little bit to a previous slide, and we've been talking about the process by which a lab school applicant becomes a lab school.

[01:19:45] On the first row of the document that was in item A of today's agenda, we spoke about the planning grant process. So just to share with the board, this is something that is under the control and authority of the Department of Education.

[01:20:02] So publicly, I wanted to share the process by which a planning grant applicant gets to the point of being ready to actually submit a lab school application. So they submit an application to the email address, which is on the website, and we acknowledge that.

[01:20:20] The very next step that we do here at the agency is that there is a committee of people who are DOE employees, former DOE employees, former people who have worked in higher education, as well as other innovative programs.

[01:20:36] That mixture of people, they take a look at those applications. We have a rubric that we use. It is available on the website for anyone to see what that rubric is and how they are scored. That team of people will review it and will score it. Based upon the scores of that review, the applicant will either be diverted for technical assistance where we have been able to meet with some of the planning grant applicants and we've said that cannot work or there's something over here we'd like for you to communicate better and we've been and we've given

[01:21:13] them the opportunity to resubmit and some of those resubmissions did become approved plan and grant applicants there have also been other situations where some of the applicants removed themselves from the process some applicants elected not to resubmit and then some applicants were not able to have a successful plan and grant applicant yet once an applicant is approved we send to each of those applicants an approval letter and a grant award and what that is it is the process by which that lab school applicant gets their funds and i will jump to the funding

[01:21:51] in just a little bit but it starts a process by which they will have a year to develop their full lab school application all planning grant applicants have exactly one year to do that there is a process where they will submit reports to the department of education about the process of how they are going about developing their application. And as they submit those reports, they get partial disbursements of their $200,000. So let me jump ahead to where we kind of were.

[01:22:25] So in the College Partnership Laboratory Schools Fund, under the legislation, what it did is it provided $5 million for us to disperse planning grants to applicants. That is the total sum that we are able to do that in that what we do is we award up to two hundred thousand dollars for every single planning grant applicant some in some cases have asked for less which is why some of those numbers are not perfectly around two hundred thousand dollar multiples at this point you will

[01:22:58] see that we have awarded 57 of those funds already we do have another group of applicants and that's the yellow part, 16%, should they all be approved, that would mean that we have about another 16% of the funding will go out to the potential applicants. Those are the ones in the works currently. And that does leave us with a balance of about $1,375,259, which is about 27%.

[01:23:30] If you take a multiple of 200, it will tell you that at some point we are going to run out of planning grants applicants. It is not a bottomless pool. However, with the slowing down, it may very well have been a good estimation to have set that limited $5 million of the $100 million lab school fund for that.

So the next step in planning grants, as Chairman Wodeska did point out earlier, is that we are looking to support these lab schools and to give them a PLC. And working with the Governor's

[01:24:04] Office and the Secretary of Ed, on May the 3rd, we are planning on having a boot camp. And that will be for all planning grant applicants, as well as lab school applicants. And we are inviting them to come together into a space. We are looking to have some of those applicants share what they're doing with each other, essentially speed dating. Here's my idea. Here's what I'm proposing. And here are the challenges. Here are the walls that I'm facing. Here are some of the things in the code the standards of quality or the standards of accreditation that we are concerned we don't know how to cross that bridge and to bounce ideas off of each other it's essentially that first opportunity

[01:24:44] for them to be able to grow together and also for us to get feedback from them about the process itself so that is coming up the details of that are still in development but we do look forward to being able to meet with the applicants and being able to help them through this one-year process of having a good lab school application come to us which we've been speaking about previously of the process so that when the application comes through they've already got every box checked on the application when it does come through thank you absolutely comments or

[01:25:23] questions for members of the committee no i love the idea that go ahead i love the idea of the plc I love the boot camp, too, and I'm also just excited to see the diversity of the applications, at least just even on the simple table that you put together.

[01:25:42] So it's exciting. I think that what jumped out at me is the interactive map. So great to be able to just go right there, click, and be able to see what's going on with a particular area, and then have the applications online.

[01:25:58] That, I think, makes it so transparent and so much more clear to the public what is happening with this. i would say if there was anything i could wish for i would love to see that interactive map concept expanded to governor schools the charter schools the innovation high school group that pulled down money several years ago to be able to really try to see what's going on with all of these different initiatives that we've had over the years to try to build out innovative approaches and then also what are the results yes what's happened and i think that for the lab schools that's one of the

[01:26:35] areas i'm going to be looking for is down the road what will we find out from these different approaches that helps us to inform what should be happening across our comprehensive schools across the state not just in the lab schools that's off to you for the work you've done on this the whole staff and there are many more staff across the agency who have done a lot of work in building these tools and what is interesting you you hit the nail on the head the purpose of the lab schools really is to be a laboratory to inform better practice and we're hoping that they

[01:27:10] will be able to do that out across the commonwealth to do that but you've already pointed it out that it's already starting to inform some of our practices here at the doe about informing innovation and informing the commonwealth about what is working what is going well there are many other you know we've got again school divisions of innovation k-12 innovation grants that go out there to be able to share with the commonwealth about what is happening in your neighborhood what is possible communicating that type of thing out these practices these hurry up and get it done

[01:27:45] type of things are jumping us into a space where we are doing some different things unique things and they are informing practice here at the agency itself it's informing innovation here at the agency itself mr hanson or mr rotherham i agree with what mr bailey just said i think the dlc and we talked about this in the last board meeting sort of the work to build a real genuine ecosystem and it's that that's what's going to take to change things over time and it's really

[01:28:17] exciting to see thank you and uh for for the benefit of the public the lab committee members are aware of this but dr album will be a fixture at the lab committee meetings he has a standing place on our agenda at every meeting to provide an update on what's going on with the planning grants. Even though that is a function of the agency, and this really came out of a suggestion from Mr. Hansen, so that we have a siteline, a pipeline of the work that may be coming before us and really wanting to create this ecosystem, we felt it was important that we stay connected to

[01:28:54] the planning grant applicants as well in their processes. So thank you, and we look forward to next month's update a pleasure all right at this time i'm going to open it up for comments from the lab committee members on discussion of current issues i have a couple items that i'll put up upon the conclusion of any remarks but i want to first open it up to the committee members i am thrilled that this process is moving forward and that there are banks on the river now i think that will be so helpful to all of our educators out in the field that are saying i'd like to pursue

[01:29:33] this but i'm not real sure i think that what you're doing is providing real clarity to people who have to ask the question and then answer it would we like to pursue this or not and then to answer the question of why would we go forward that they'll know much more clearly now what the what the banks are so that they'll know whether they can fit into those banks or not so thank you for that and i would say that just for the current issues is really echoes what you just said um

[01:30:06] madam chairman and that is uh chairwoman and that is that being able to know what's coming next i think will allow all of us on the committee to really foreshadow what we need to be thinking about in terms of our commitments um to making this work move forward so thank you mr bailey no just again just echoing those comments and i think some of the points we made before that all this just gives certainty um and it just helps remove some of the the confusion that i think had been there and so i just appreciate that i think it helps us move faster i think it'll help

[01:30:41] applications move faster i think just um also in um just an acknowledgement of you madam chairwoman too the the commitment to transparency is part of this process too so not only is it a simpler process and one that's better aligned to the statute but also one that's very committed to making sure this is done in a transparent way and involves the public to make sure there's a durable support on their end too so thank you for that mr rotherham i have nothing to add i

[01:31:14] completely i completely agree and nothing thank you and mr hansen thank you i appreciate both of of you, in particular, even when making the time to virtually participate, even though not necessary, much appreciated and demonstrates your commitment and engagement in this work as well. So with that, let me just round out, as chair of the committee, there's a number of items that I work on behind the scenes with Dr. Moran and the staff, and I want to

[01:31:53] just surface a couple of those items here for the, again, in the interest of transparency and so we can kind of stage the work as we're building out this ecosystem. I know that job one right now is to support planning grant applicants and to support the lab school applicants.

[01:32:11] However, in the future, as we're moving through this, here are the items that I think in the conversation that Dr. Moran and I have had that I think would really benefit this process. The first is, I think we'd like to see at the committee, I'm going to call it a 10-year history of innovation in education in Virginia and by this I really want to again to Dr. Moran a geomap that denotes the various types of schools we've had over those 10 years where are they located

[01:32:46] and should we have data around what has worked um what are moments of growth uh you know for example the governor's stem schools I remember when I was on the state board of education we were we approved a large number of those, and they were very successful, and they were partnerships between K-12 and higher education. I'd be curious to know what's the status of those schools, what's worked, because I think that that information is going to be incredibly beneficial for the lab school applicants, for the planning grant winners, and for future, again, we're

[01:33:20] creating this kind of flexible catalog of knowledge that can benefit all. So I think we'd like to see in 10 years, you know, I'll leave it to staff to determine what's the appropriate snapshot. I just, I picked up that number. I knew that that's when the STEM schools had started, which were akin to what we're talking about here. But seeing it on a map would be very helpful. And here in particular is also why that's being raised. A number of years ago, we worked on childhood hunger in the Commonwealth of Virginia. And at that time, we put onto a map where were

[01:33:54] food banks, where were summer feeding sites, where were mobile food trucks? And we put on the same map where was the need. And when you look at it in a map, very quickly you're able to see, oh, some parts of the state have capacity or have been working on this for a while, and maybe some parts of the state don't have the support or the capacity that they need to pursue a particular topic. And so it also helps understand how to support applicants. And so I think that would be a benefit for kind of a future homework assignment. The second is to really think about

[01:34:32] creating a process to apply learning. I'm going to call, sometimes in this process, we're going to have points of learning. Some might even call it points of friction because we're working with applicants that are coming from a higher ed context. And the rules, the code is very different in higher ed, say, than it is in K-12. As information, for example, the boot camp allows us, gives us kind of our first opportunity. Through that boot camp, I suspect there will be items

[01:35:09] broadly shared across the planning grant winners where they need more information. And let's think about how to formalize that process so that as we're learning what are these points of friction, that we can improve and refine the FAQs. We can improve and refine the application. We can improve and refine the information on the website so that it isn't kind of a hunt and peck, that it's a system that is supporting applicants. It's a system that is supporting

[01:35:44] the planning grant winners and that we're doing it really in modeling best in class for innovation. I want you to think about that. How do we identify those points? And then give us a read-in on that at the next meeting. I mean, we'll have our meeting May 1st. So I think it'll really have to be, you know, that could be a drop us an email and then we can have a public discussion about it in our June meeting. But those points of friction, those points of learning, that's going to be beneficial for all of us to know. The third is, and I've raised this and I've heard this from a number of the committee members already, we're going to need pathways to resolve points of

[01:36:19] friction or points of learning. And this could come in the following form. Number one, we could have an applicant that needs intensive technical assistance because they don't know something and they need to learn about it. Number two, the pathway to resolve that could be more knowledge and technical assistance. We could have an applicant that comes forward and they are challenged to follow the code. And as we've discussed, the code is the code, the law is the law. We don't have discretion on that. However, sometimes there are items where there can be a

[01:36:54] waiver request put in before the State Board of Education. I think, again, and the applicant wouldn't know that by their very nature coming in from being in higher education. What are those elements for which they may request a waiver from the State Board of Education? And is there any flexibility? I think there are some requirements that have flexibility. There are some that do not and should not. But I, we have an opportunity and again, kind of a responsibility. We can identify those. If we know these are going to be points of friction, let's identify those points of friction

[01:37:31] and let's transparently catalog. If this is a part, is it a waivable, you know, is a requirement for compliance, those 31 requirements, are any of those waivable or are they all non-waivable? Let's, let's again, like transparently catalog that because I think that's going to help in the deliberation for video internally to, for example, we could anticipate where an applicant may come forward. And as a contingency for their application to be approved, they may need to have a waiver

[01:38:04] approved as well. And a concrete example of that is the use of seat time. There is a process that you can go through to look at seat time waivers in Virginia, but you probably need

[01:38:39] technical assistance to think about that as you're building out a lab school concept. And so those are the kinds of things that I think that they're ones that it's a no-go to get a waiver. And then there are some where there may be a path and that the technical assistance that the state's department can provide can be very helpful in that process. Or here's an old-fashioned example for those of you who've known, have been in public service for a while, being able to start school before Labor day. For many, many years, local school divisions had to request a permission to start before labor

[01:39:14] day. You know, those are examples of things where there is flexibility. There's flex built into the code, but you have to know to be able to request it and what that process is, which is separate from our process here. So we want to support applicants that way. So that's kind of pathways. I'm going to call it pathways to resolve friction. The fourth, and this really comes from some of the expertise on this committee. What we'd like to see is a catalog of some of the new federal flexibilities and new federal funding opportunities that are available to institutions of higher

[01:39:48] education that may support a sustainability of this innovation work. And let me give you a concrete example. In the last several months, there's been new flexibility granted by the Department of Labor and Department of Education together with regard to paid apprenticeships for teachers. That funding can be used in new and innovative ways to help address the teacher shortage across the nation. Typically, that type of information is shared with K-12 schools or

[01:40:24] would be shared with, say, a workforce center here in the Commonwealth. But that information may or not have always been shared with institutions of higher education and they may not have the benefit of that information so i think it's important as there are new challenges that we are all addressing for example really the teacher shortage being a very concrete example where new flexibility

has been provided to states new flexibility has been provided to local education agencies as well as as institutions of higher education and one-stops to really address these items. And that federal

[01:41:03] support, that federal flex on where something previously was a non-waivable item, for us to be up to date on that, I would like to see that information become readily available through our process. Mr. Bailey? No, I think this is exciting. I mean, you're right, there's new flexibilities.

[01:41:25] there's also I mean almost two trillion of of dollars coming out of the the infrastructure act the inflation reduction act and also the chips act and mo a lot of that is going through universities most of the programs require workforce and other education plans and so it's a wonderful opportunity i think for as virginia institutions are competing for some of those funds whether it's regional innovation hubs even the broadband dollars there's a number of nsf funds again universities are going to be competing for that and there's a way of thinking about what are the what's the role of lab schools as part of some of those federal funding programs but it's also as

[01:42:04] part of some of these innovation uh infrastructure programs too so happy to work with staff but we can now begin to try to connect the dots there because i think a lot of the education federal funds they're sun setting in about 14 months give or take um and but there's a lot of other funds that will be coming in through universities and through other local economic development agencies.

[01:42:25] Well, we will happily rely upon and utilize your expertise, Mr. Bailey. And I know Mr. Rotherham and Mr. Hansen are well acquainted on these topics as well. And that really is the beauty, I have to say, of the composition of the Lab Committee is that we really have a variety of expertise that can bring to bear to support this ecosystem. The last item, and I know this is is creating connections and partnerships with CHEV as we are working to inform better practice

[01:43:00] even though we are not required as a committee to provide information to CHEV. Dr. Moran and I have talked about this a couple times. I've requested a meeting with CHEV. I do believe that it's important to create a relationship with CHEV and to inquire how may what we're learning through the lab committees be shared to Chev? And how would you like that information? You know, in being a good partner, you know, some of the traditional definition of a lab school was really created to

[01:43:36] help refine and improve, to train teachers and to surface new teaching techniques. So there are going to be things through the lab schools that we learn, and those learnings can really help inform higher ed's practice in the Commonwealth as well. And so I think, you know, Dr. Moran and I are going to sit down with Shev. Any member of the lab committee will be welcome to join us.

[01:44:04] But we want to meet with them and ask, how can we be a good partner? What type of information would you like? When would you like that information? And how can we create, and you'll hear, you're going to hear me say the same kind of things over and over again, but how can we create connective tissue between our practice to really support an ecosystem for everyone.

[01:44:26] So those are kind of some of the things we'll be working on behind the scenes between now and our next meeting. So let me pause there and see, Mr. Chapman, do we have any public comment on non-agenda items? We do not. Thank you. With that, our next meeting will be May 1st, Monday at 10 a.m. back here in Richmond. And without any further business, we stand adjourned.

[01:44:51] And thank you very much for your time. Thank you.



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